

Cross section

Every year a tree adds a new layer of growth to its trunk and branches. Look at this slice from a tree's trunk, and you will see lots of rings. Each ring shows the growth made by the tree in one year. By counting the rings you can tell how old a tree is.

A wide ring shows that the tree grew a lot in this year.

A bad year for growth! Thin rings show how trees sometimes grow very slowly.



Shagbark hickory



Cork oak



Snakebark maple



Deodar

Evergreen trees



Mountain gum



Black spruce



The incredible hulk

What size waist do you have?

The trunk of this giant redwood in California measures 103 feet (31 meters) all the way around, and stands nearly 275 feet (84 meters) high. It is so famous it has even been given a name—General Sherman!

